

Exercise – Hosting a Static Website in Azure Storage

Objective

The objective of this exercise is to learn how to host a static website using Azure Storage Account. In this hands-on, we understand how to enable static website hosting, upload files, find the website URL, enable metrics, and finally delete the resources.

Introduction

Azure Storage allows us to host static websites directly from a storage account without using a virtual machine. Static websites contain HTML, CSS, JavaScript, and image files. In this exercise, I learned how Azure provides a simple and cost-effective way to host static content.

Step A – Enabling Static Website Hosting

First, we open the Azure Portal and create a Storage Account (General-purpose v2).

After the storage account is created:

1. Open the storage account.
2. Go to the **Overview** section.
3. Select the **Capabilities** tab.
4. Click on **Static website** option.
5. Select **Enabled**.
6. Enter **index.html** as the Index document name.
7. Enter **404.html** as the Error document path.
8. Click **Save**.

After saving, Azure generates a primary endpoint URL which will be used to access the website.

At this stage, I understood that index.html acts as the default page when users open the website.

Step B – Uploading Files to \$web Container

After enabling static website, Azure automatically creates a special container named **\$web**.

Steps followed:

1. Go to **Containers** in the storage account.
2. Select the **\$web** container.
3. Click on **Upload**.
4. Select HTML files (index.html, 404.html).
5. Ensure the content type is set to **text/html**.
6. Click **Upload**.

Once files are uploaded, they become publicly accessible through the website URL.

Step C – Finding the Website URL

To find the website URL:

1. Open the storage account.
2. Click on **Static Website**.
3. Copy the **Primary endpoint URL**.

This URL can be opened in a browser to view the hosted website.

Step D – Enabling Metrics for Static Website

Azure provides monitoring features to check website usage.

Steps followed:

1. Open the storage account.
2. Click on **Metrics** under Monitor section.
3. Select a time range and click Apply.
4. Choose **Blob** as Namespace.
5. Select **Egress** as metric.
6. Choose **Sum** as aggregation.
7. Add filter → Select **API name**.
8. Select **GetWebContent**.

This helps in tracking how many times users accessed the website content.

From this step, I understood how Azure provides monitoring support for storage services.

Step E – Deleting the Resources (Termination)

After completing the exercise, it is important to delete resources to avoid extra charges.

Steps followed:

1. Go to **Resource Groups**.
2. Select the resource group used for the storage account.
3. Click on **Delete Resource Group**.
4. Type the resource group name to confirm.
5. Click **Delete**.

This removes the storage account and all related services.

Conclusion

From this exercise, I learned how to host a static website using Azure Storage without using any server. I understood the role of the \$web container, index document, and error document. I also learned how to monitor website traffic using Azure metrics. This exercise helped me understand basic cloud hosting concepts in a practical way.